LUMEN FILM CLUB · AUTUMN 2026

OPEN MOVIES

Four short films made in the open, one for each Friday in November

6 NOV · 13 NOV · 20 NOV · 27 NOV

FRIDAYS AT 20:30 · STUDIO 2, HARBOUR ARTS CENTRE

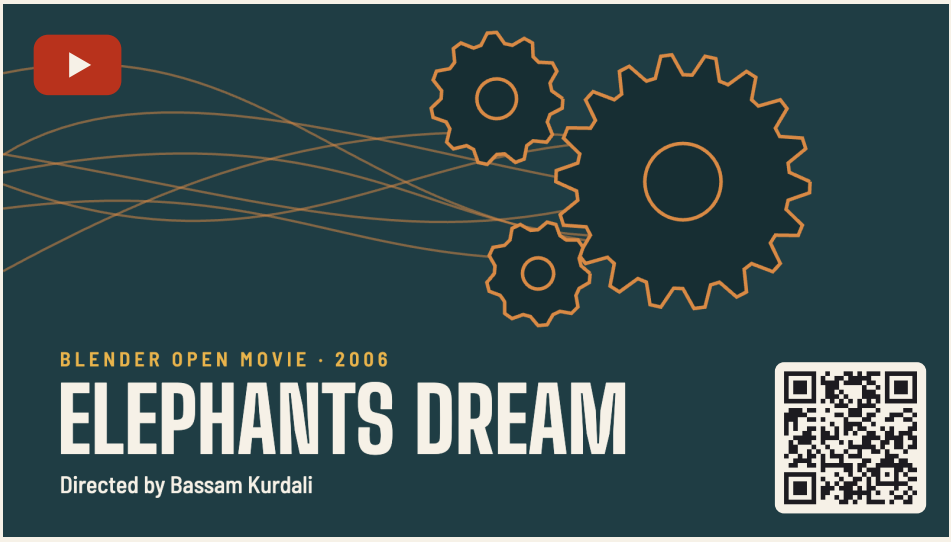
Every film in this season was made in the open. The Blender Foundation, the Dutch non-profit behind the free 3D software Blender, has produced short films since 2006 to test and improve its own tools, and it publishes each one under a Creative Commons licence together with the files used to make it. We chose four of them: Elephants Dream, the first, from 2006 (**Film 1**); Big Buck Bunny, from 2008 (**Film 2**); Tears of Steel, shot with actors in Amsterdam in 2012 (**Film 3**); and Spring, from 2019 (**Film 4**).

None of them runs longer than twelve minutes, so each evening pairs one film with half an hour of conversation. Every film page carries a title card with a code in its corner. Point a phone camera at the code and the film opens on YouTube; in the PDF of this programme the card itself is the link. If you miss a Friday, watch at home and come to the next one.

SESSION 1 · FRIDAY 6 NOVEMBER

ELEPHANTS DREAM

Directed by Bassam Kurdali · Netherlands, 2006 · 11 min · English



Film 1. Elephants Dream. Project Orange, Blender Foundation.

CC BY 2.5 · youtu.be/TLkA0RELQ1g

Emo, a young man, follows the older Proog through a machine that seems to have no end: rooms of switchboards and cables, a flock of mechanical birds, a lift thrown upwards through a row of shutters. Proog believes in the machine and wants Emo to admire it. Emo does not see what Proog sees, and the film leaves the question open on purpose.

Elephants Dream was made in Amsterdam from September 2005 by a team of seven artists, under the code name Project Orange, with money from DVD pre-sales and the Netherlands Media Art Institute. When it came out in March 2006 the production files went online with it, so anyone could study how each shot was built. The voices are Cas Jansen and Tygo Gernandt, and the score is by Jan Morgenstern.

SESSION 2 · FRIDAY 13 NOVEMBER

BIG BUCK BUNNY

Directed by Sacha Goedegebure · Netherlands, 2008 · 10 min · No dialogue



Film 2. Big Buck Bunny. Project Peach, Blender Institute.

CC BY 3.0 · youtu.be/aqz-KE-bpKQ

A large and gentle rabbit spends his morning watching butterflies until three rodents, led by a flying squirrel, start pelting him with fruit and kill two of the butterflies. He answers with a series of traps. Nobody speaks: the story is told in timing and gesture, as in the cartoon shorts it remembers.

Project Peach brought seven artists to the Blender Institute in Amsterdam from October 2007 to April 2008, and the film had its premiere there on 10 April 2008. The fur, hair and grass of the forest pushed the software forward, and the new features reached everyone in Blender 2.46. Because it is bright, varied and free to use, Big Buck Bunny is also a standard test clip for video players, so you may have seen it before without knowing its name.

SESSION 3 · FRIDAY 20 NOVEMBER

TEARS OF STEEL

Written and directed by Ian Hubert · Netherlands, 2012 · 12 min · English



Film 3. Tears of Steel. Project Mango, Blender Institute.

CC BY 3.0 · youtu.be/R6MlUcmOul8

Forty years after a young couple break up on a bridge in Amsterdam, the robots built by one of them have taken over the city. A team of scientists gathers in the Oude Kerk to stage that moment again and change how it ends. It is the only live-action film of the season: the actors were filmed in Amsterdam, and the sets, the robots and the battle were added in Blender.

Project Mango ran through 2012 to improve Blender's visual-effects tools, such as camera tracking and compositing, and part of its money came from the Netherlands Film Fund. The film was released online on 26 September 2012. Derek de Lint plays the older Thom, and Joris Kerbosch shot it. Stay for the credits, which the makers ask every screening to keep.

SESSION 4 · FRIDAY 27 NOVEMBER

SPRING

Written and directed by Andy Goralczyk · Netherlands, 2019 · 8 min · No dialogue



Film 4. Spring. Blender Studio.

CC BY 4.0 · youtu.be/WhWc3b3KhnY

A shepherd girl and her dog climb down from the sunlit heights into a frozen forest, where giant spirits hold back the change of season. With her staff and a chime she has to lead them out of the valley, so that the ice can melt. Nobody speaks; the music of Torin Borrowdale carries the story from the first shot to the last.

Andy Goralczyk, who had animated on Elephants Dream thirteen years earlier, wrote and directed the film, drawing on his childhood in the mountains of Germany. The team started in Blender 2.79 and moved early to 2.80, then still in beta, so Spring served as a test of that release. It had its premiere on YouTube on 4 April 2019, and its characters and files are published under CC BY 4.0.

PRACTICAL NOTES

AT THE CLUB

Studio 2, Harbour Arts Centre · Doors open at 20:00

Screenings start at 20:30. Entry is free for members and €3 for guests; membership costs €15 a year and can be paid at the door. The studio seats sixty, and the conversation after each film lasts about half an hour.

WHY WE CAN SHOW THESE FILMS

Each film is published under a Creative Commons Attribution licence, which lets anyone copy, share and screen the work, in public and with an entry fee, as long as the makers are credited. The Blender Foundation asks that the credit roll stay at the end of each film, and we keep it.

WATCHING AT HOME

The codes on the title cards open the films on Blender's YouTube channels. If your phone does not read a code, type the short address printed under the picture. The PDF of this programme, on the club's website, links each card to its film.

CREDITS

Elephants Dream © 2006 Blender Foundation and Netherlands Media Art Institute · CC BY 2.5 · orange.blender.org

Big Buck Bunny © 2008 Blender Foundation · CC BY 3.0 · peach.blender.org

Tears of Steel © 2012 Blender Foundation · CC BY 3.0 · mango.blender.org

Spring © 2019 Blender Foundation (Blender Studio) · CC BY 4.0 · studio.blender.org

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